AJAY BALAJI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategy professional with 4+ years of experience across Strategy& (PwC) and manufacturing. Proven track record working with CXOs on corporate strategy, GTM design, market entry, B2B growth, and operating model transformation across FMCG, agrochemicals, electronics, aviation, and industrial sectors. Delivered ₹800 Cr+ incremental revenue impact; adept at translating strategy into measurable execution through structured problem-solving, field research, and cross-functional governance.

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

Year	Qualification	Institute	Score
2024	MBA (PGP)	Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIM-B)	3.1 / 4.0 CGPA
2020	B.E. – Mechanical Engineering (Rank Holder – 11 / 7,400+)	Anna University (SSEC)	9.1 / 10 CGPA
2016	Class XII (CBSE)	Modern Senior Secondary School, Chennai	93%

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Associate Consultant | *Strategy& (Global Strategy Consulting Arm of PwC)* — Jul 2024 – Present

Corporate Strategy & Group Strategy Office

- Anchored setup of Group Strategy Office for ₹11,000 Cr+ conglomerate; designed planning calendar, governance cadence, and strategic review framework aligned to conglomerate structure
- Unlocked ₹800 Cr+ incremental revenue and built 5-year growth roadmap for ₹1,500 Cr+ agrochemicals SBU; synthesised insights from 15+ competitor benchmarks to define strategic priorities
- Architected M&A and CVC investment thesis enabling structured capital allocation across business units
- Drove execution governance via KPI scorecards and RACI frameworks across all business units

B2B Growth Strategy – FMEG Sector

- Assessed operating model of two B2B divisions (dry cell battery & professional lighting) for a leading Indian FMEG company; mapped revenue leakages and structural inefficiencies
- Conducted demand estimation across product segments to size addressable opportunity and whitespace for market share gain; supplemented with competitor interviews and field immersions
- Executed detailed internal capability mapping across Sales, Supply Chain, and Finance; identified critical gaps limiting growth
- Initiated end-to-end sales excellence programme: B2B lead pipeline structuring, key account management frameworks, portfolio optimisation, target-setting and governance redesign
- Revamped Rewards & Recognition policy and upgraded back-end supply chain processes (vendor management, pricing architecture) to unlock operational leverage
- Initiatives collectively designed to drive 40%+ topline revenue growth within 12 months across both divisions

Market Entry Strategy

- Spearheaded B2B2C market entry strategy for Japanese electronics MNC; unlocked ₹1,700 Cr+ revenue potential
- Prioritised 50+ cities using demand analytics, macro indicators, and real-estate density to define phased expansion roadmap
- Identified whitespace opportunities via 40+ competitor benchmarks; shaped channel and GTM strategy
- Enabled 3+ strategic partnerships by structuring offering design and commercialisation approach

GTM Strategy – Industrial Sector

- Designed nationwide GTM strategy for PVC-pipes manufacturer enabling scalable channel expansion across Tier 2/3 markets
- Built granular state-level market intelligence engine mapping demand, competition intensity, and channel density
- Generated field-validated insights through structured immersions with customers and retail distributors

Operating Model Transformation

- Led operating model transformation for Middle East aviation group; realigned organisational structure to long-term strategy
- Built and prioritised 20+ transformation initiatives with clear ownership, milestones, and KPIs
- Designed shared services model improving cross-functional efficiency and governance across group entities

Graduate Engineer Trainee – Process Engineer | *Delphi-TVS Technologies* — Oct 2020 – Jul 2021

Capacity Improvement & Operations

- Commissioned new testing line (5 machines); increased production volume capacity by 25%+, project value ₹7 Cr+
- Installed and qualified injector test machine delivering 9%+ volume gain; optimised factory layout design, project value ₹1 Cr+
- Spearheaded 3+ vendor negotiations reducing machine handover time by 2+ weeks; contract value ₹1 Cr+
- Implemented poka-yoke in 5 injector test machine fixtures; drafted SOP and reduced defective output by 2%+

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Fastest Promotion, Strategy& 2025 – Promoted from Associate to Senior Associate in 8 months with top rating (1/4 scale); fastest in cohort
- University Rank Holder, Anna University 2020 – Ranked 11 out of 7,400+ graduates (top 0.1 percentile); scored 10/10 GPA in 30 of 66 courses
- National Winner, SAE-BAJA Sales Event 2018 – Ranked 1 of 60+ teams; designed winning business plan; event footfall 10,000+; prize ₹40,000
- National Finalist, Preethi Appliances Innovation Challenge 2020 – Ranked top 3 of 40+ teams; redesigned mixer cooling by 50%+

LEADERSHIP & POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

- Recruitment Coordinator, Strategy& (2025) – Coordinated IIMB summer placements; managed end-to-end logistics and candidate pipeline
- Secretary, iQ – IIMB Quiz Club (2023–24) – Chief editor of campus newsletter; organised 2 inter-collegiate quiz festivals
- Secretary, National Level Mechanical Symposium, SSEC (2018–20) – Elected (1 of 50+); conducted 6+ events, footfall 800+
- President, Organising Committee – Math Convention, SSEC (2019) – Supervised 25+ members; organised 4+ events, footfall 500+
- Founder, Science Club, SSEC (2017) – Grew to 200+ members; coordinated 2 guest talks and 3 inter-school quizzes
- Team Manager, SAE BAJA ATV Racing (2018) – Managed ₹7L+ budget; raised ₹60,000+ external funding

KEY SKILLS & TOOLS

Strategy Domains	Corporate Strategy, GTM Design, Market Entry, B2B Growth Strategy, Operating Model Transformation, M&A/CVC, Sales Excellence, Execution Governance
Industry Exposure	FMCG / FMEG, Agrochemicals, Consumer Electronics, PVC Pipes / Industrial, Aviation (Middle East), Automotive / Manufacturing
Tools & Frameworks	Market sizing, competitive benchmarking, financial modelling, KPI scorecards, RACI frameworks, field research, demand analytics
Soft Skills	Executive stakeholder management (CXO-level), structured problem-solving, cross-functional leadership, client communication